# Discovery Phase Questionnaire

# Introduction

This document outlines a structured set of discovery questions intended to gather critical business and operational requirements for the proposed fundraising platform. The responses to these questions will directly inform the system architecture, user experience design, financial workflows, and scalability strategy.

As the platform aims to support diverse stakeholders—including donors, volunteers, institutions, and corporate partners—it is essential to clearly define workflows, responsibilities, and success criteria at this early stage. Accurate and detailed input will ensure that the resulting system is aligned with organizational goals, minimizes development risks, and delivers measurable impact.

# 1. Entity Types & Workflows

To properly design user roles, permissions, and onboarding flows, we need clarity on the different types of fundraisers and their operational models.

- What are the primary fundraiser entity types (e.g., Individual Fundraisers, University Chapters, Corporate Partners)? Are there additional categories?

Is the question asking for who the targets of the Apps will be. If so, please check my note below.

Primary fundraiser Entity types:  Individual fundraisers, Universities, Corporate/Business partners, Celebrities/Influencers, Diaspora community

Secondary targets we seek to get support from: Foundations, Donor organizations

- What are the onboarding steps required for each entity type? (e.g., identity verification, approval workflows, training requirements)

- What permissions and capabilities should each entity type have within the system?

- How do goals differ across entity types? (e.g., fundraising targets, campaign duration, impact expectations)

Fundraising targets, Campaign durations, University targets, Impact target, Community Target

- Should entity types have hierarchical structures (e.g., university → chapters → members)?

- How are verified or high-profile fundraisers (e.g., celebrities or corporate partners) distinguished and managed?
- Can users belong to multiple entity types simultaneously, and how should role conflicts be handled?

# 2. The 'Water Project' Lifecycle

Understanding the full lifecycle of a water project is critical for designing workflows, state transitions, and tracking systems.

- What is the complete step-by-step journey of a water project, from initial identification to completion?

**Project lifecycle (workflow)**

- Intake & Prioritization
    - Sources: community request, government referral, CSR partner nomination, internal targeting.

    - Triage criteria: community need, population served, feasibility (water source, access), community readiness, alignment with strategy.
    - Output: prioritized project list and proposed start window.
- Site Assessment & Planning
    - Location research: hydro/geo checks, access, permissions, beneficiary mapping.
    - Resource check: machinery/equipment needs, local suppliers, technician availability.
    - Stakeholder alignment: local government body approvals
    - Deliverable: Site Assessment Report + draft timeline
- Agreement & Permits
    - Secure formal sign-offs (local authorities, partner organizations)
- Implementation / Construction
    - Procure and mobilize machinery and materials; install systems according to standards.
    - Parallel activities: communications to donors (announce launch), student ambassador engagement, recruit and train community guardians.
    - Deliverable: Installation Checklist + Handover Pack agreement and Hand over the project to Gov body (Woreda Water Bureau) and WASHco.
- Community Onboarding & Handover
    - Appoint/ elect Guardians (water committee (WASH committee) + paid/volunteer technician), deliver WASH training to the committee, set up maintenance finance mechanism (community money collection modality, transparency).
    - Establish operations calendar: routine checks, monthly collections, reporting cadence.

- Who is responsible for identifying and submitting new project opportunities?

Mostly, Leadership team do that but any staff members will pass along if any opportunity is coming up.

- What validation or approval steps are required before a project becomes publicly visible?

- The site Engineer checks the quality and functionality of the well. The Woreda Water office technicians also check the water Well functionality and quality check before the project becomes for public visibility.
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- What are the key stages of a project (e.g., proposed → approved → fundraising → funded → implementation → completed)?

The methodology differs from case to case. We offer/follow different approaches.

Method 1: Internal/team agreement on proposed project →Introductory Donor Meeting/Pitch→ Propose a Project →Secure Partners → detail Project proposal doc preparation, development →Team Review and submission to donors → approved by Donors → funded by donors→ implementation → completed.

Method 2: Internal/team agreement on proposed project →Proposal Development → Donor scooping → Proposal Submission →donor Approval →Implementation →completed

Method 3: Internal/team agreement on proposed project → Proposal Development → Donor scooping → Proposal Submission →donor Approval →Implementation →completed

- What criteria determine when a project moves from one stage to the next?

There is supervision from site engineer at each milestone such as Mobilization, Site clearing and excavation, Construction, Masonry works, Pipes and lines installation, Installation of accessories, Finishing and Marble work for signboard.

- What data and documentation are required at each stage (e.g., needs assessment, cost estimates, progress reports)?

Feasibility study report, cost breakdown, Reports

- How is project completion defined, and what constitutes “water flowing”?

The site engineer checks the Full Functionality of the water point where right installments are made, Water is discharging, finishings are completed and proper hand over is made.

- Are there post-completion monitoring or maintenance phases that need to be tracked?

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We don't have formal Maintenance check phases for every project after project completion but that has been in our plan where we structure more robust Monitoring and Maintenance systems are in place. The only reason we didn't do it is because of lack of resources. But there are communities who sometimes communicate for some maintenance related issues and we respond accordingly.

# 3. Financial Logic & Transparency

A clear and trustworthy financial model is essential for donor confidence and operational integrity.

- How are donations collected and held (e.g., pooled accounts, escrow, campaign-specific wallets)?

- When and how are funds released for project execution?

When the full campaign targets are achieved and funds are secured.

- How should the system handle partial funding or overfunding scenarios?

- How does corporate matching work? What triggers a match (e.g., donation thresholds, campaign milestones)?

Donation Thresholds I would say. It could be percentage target.

- Are there rules for allocating matched funds across campaigns?

I am hoping the matchings are done for specific campaigns so we should know which matching is made for which campaign.

- What level of financial transparency should be provided to donors (e.g., real-time totals, breakdown of fund usage)?

Breakdown of fund usage along with project progress

- What proof of impact is required after funds are used (e.g., photos, videos, GPS coordinates, reports)?

Photos, GPS coordinates, reports. In the near future, if resources are secured, Realtime montoring will update donors' real-time data of the water well.

- How should proof of impact be delivered back to donors (e.g., notifications, dashboards, reports)?

It will be good to set up Notifications updates for major project progress update, but we will also provide Completion report at the end.

- Are there audit, compliance, or reporting requirements that must be supported?

Yes, all the organization annual Audit report, License certifications (compliances) and annual reports will be provided.

# 4. Volunteer Engagement

The "Volunteer Client" persona is central to project initiation and fundraising success.

- How do volunteers initiate a new water project within the system?
- What information and tools do they need to successfully launch and manage a campaign?
- Should volunteers be able to create and manage their own fundraising pages?
- What support features are needed for volunteers (e.g., templates, guides, media upload tools)?
- How should volunteers track their progress toward fundraising goals?
- Are there incentives or recognition systems for volunteers (e.g., badges, leaderboards, milestones)?
- How do volunteers communicate updates to donors and supporters?

- Should volunteers collaborate with others (teams, chapters), and how should that be managed?

# 5. Success Metrics

Defining clear success metrics ensures the platform is aligned with organizational impact goals.

- What are the primary metrics for the platform? (e.g., total funds raised, number of completed water projects)

Total funds raised, number of campaigns ran successfully, Number of coprorates companies matching secured and completed water projects

- What donor-related metrics are critical (e.g., recurring donor rate, donor retention, average donation size)?

Recurring donor rate, Donor retention, Increased donation

- What volunteer engagement metrics matter most (e.g., active volunteers, campaigns per volunteer)?

Number of volunteers engaged running successful campaigns
Number of new campaigns initiated by volunteers
Number of volunteers raised highest

- How should project impact be measured and reported (e.g., number of people served, regions covered)?

Number of Water projects completed, number of individuals served, number of students reached number of institutes (health centers, schools) served.

- What operational metrics are important for internal management (e.g., approval time, project completion rate)?

Project
Project completion rate

- How frequently should these metrics be reported, and to whom?